

Oberlin Investments in Israeli Companies Total More Than \$1.2 Million, Investigation Finds

An investigation by The Review identified more than \$52 million of Oberlin College's investments across Europe, Asia, and the Middle East.

In the 2021-22 fiscal year, fund managers employed by Oberlin College invested more than \$1.2 million in four Israeli tech companies, according to tax documents uncovered by *The Review*.

The documents, which have not previously been reported, detail more than \$52 million in investments made on the college's behalf between July 1, 2021 and June 30, 2022. The investments span 69 companies in 22 countries around the world. Their publication marks the first time that the public has been given detailed access to the college's investment portfolio, which has previously been kept a closely guarded secret of the college's fund managers.

The four Israeli companies – Fireblocks, Mobilesson, Orca Security, and Cyber Hunters – are all part of the thriving Israeli tech sector. Two – Orca and Cyber Hunters – specialize in cybersecurity. Mobilesson Ltd, which does business under the alias ConnectTeam, makes a brand of HR productivity software. Fireblocks Ltd maintains software infrastructure for cryptocurrency and digital financial transactions, largely serving as a backend for other financial technology apps like Revolut.

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Company	Country	Investment	Sector	Description
Fireblocks Ltd.	Israel	\$477,298	Software & Tech	Backend infrastructure for digital money transfers and cryptocurrency
Mobilesson Ltd.	Israel	\$384,713	Software & Tech	HR software
Orca Security Ltd.	Israel	\$239,026	Cybersecurity	Cybersecurity firm specializing in cloud security
Cyber Hunters Ltd.	Israel	\$135,242	Cybersecurity	Cybersecurity software for small companies
Rehab and Mental Healthcare Group B.V.	Netherlands	\$962,628	NA	[No verifiable details]
Paper Education Company Inc	Canada	\$873,406	Education	Live tutoring for K-12 students

Twice, in April 2024 and April 2025, Oberlin students have filed petitions requesting that the Board of Trustees divest from Israeli companies. Both times, the Board has rejected calls for

divestment on grounds including its fiduciary responsibility to maintain the financial health of the endowment, a desire to prioritize engagement with world affairs over disengagement, and the college's use of capital funds to manage its investments.

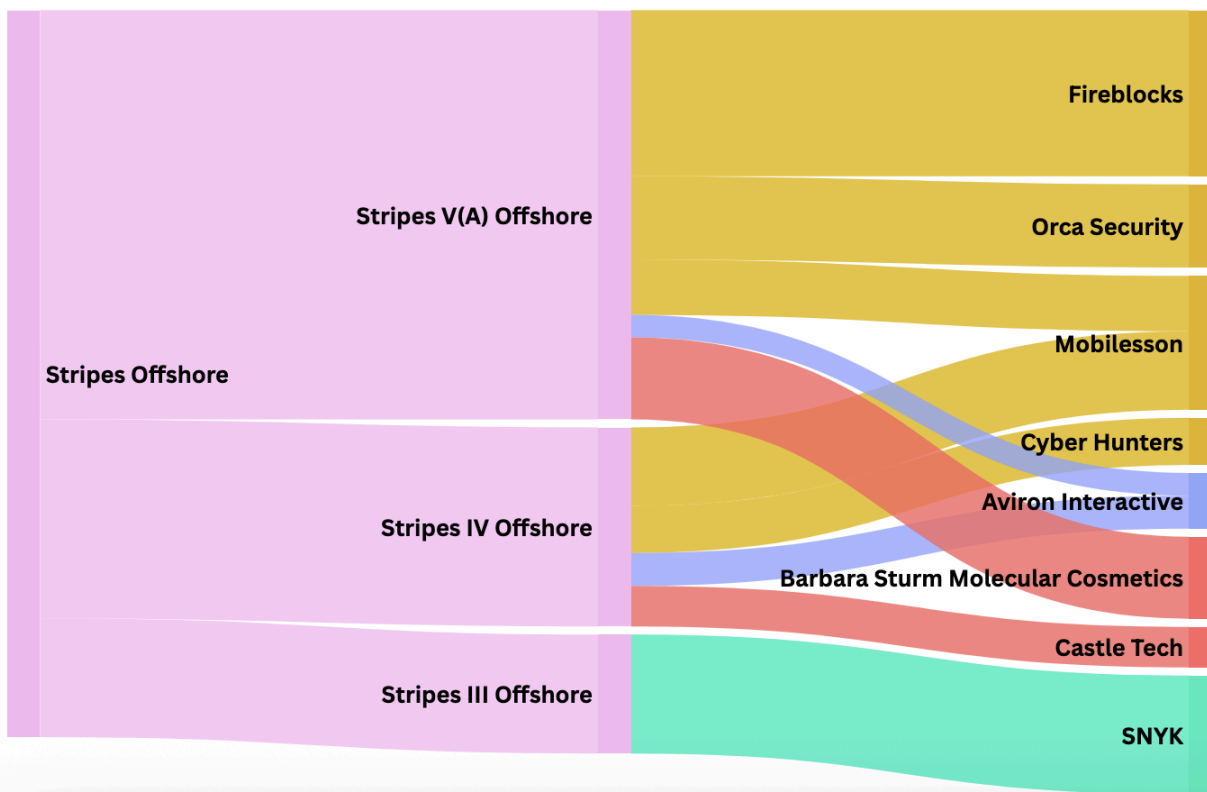
Such capital funds take investments from one or more shareholders and themselves make investments in one or more companies. For this reason, divestment from specific Israeli companies would require the college to divest wholesale from a larger fund – potentially also terminating investments in unrelated companies.

The Review's investigation found that, in the 2021 fiscal year, all investments in Israeli companies in the College's portfolio were made through two branches of the same fund: Stripes Offshore. That same year, Stripes Offshore invested a total of \$2 million on the College's behalf, of which 60% went to Israeli companies. The remaining \$0.8 million went to four companies in Germany, Canada, and the United Kingdom, respectively.

In 2021, 60% of all investments made through Stripes Offshore went to Israeli companies

The fund invested \$2M on Oberlin's behalf, of which \$1.2M went to Fireblocks, Orca, Mobilesson, or Cyber Hunters. All of Oberlin's Israeli investments that year were handled through Stripes.

Israel Canada Germany United Kingdom

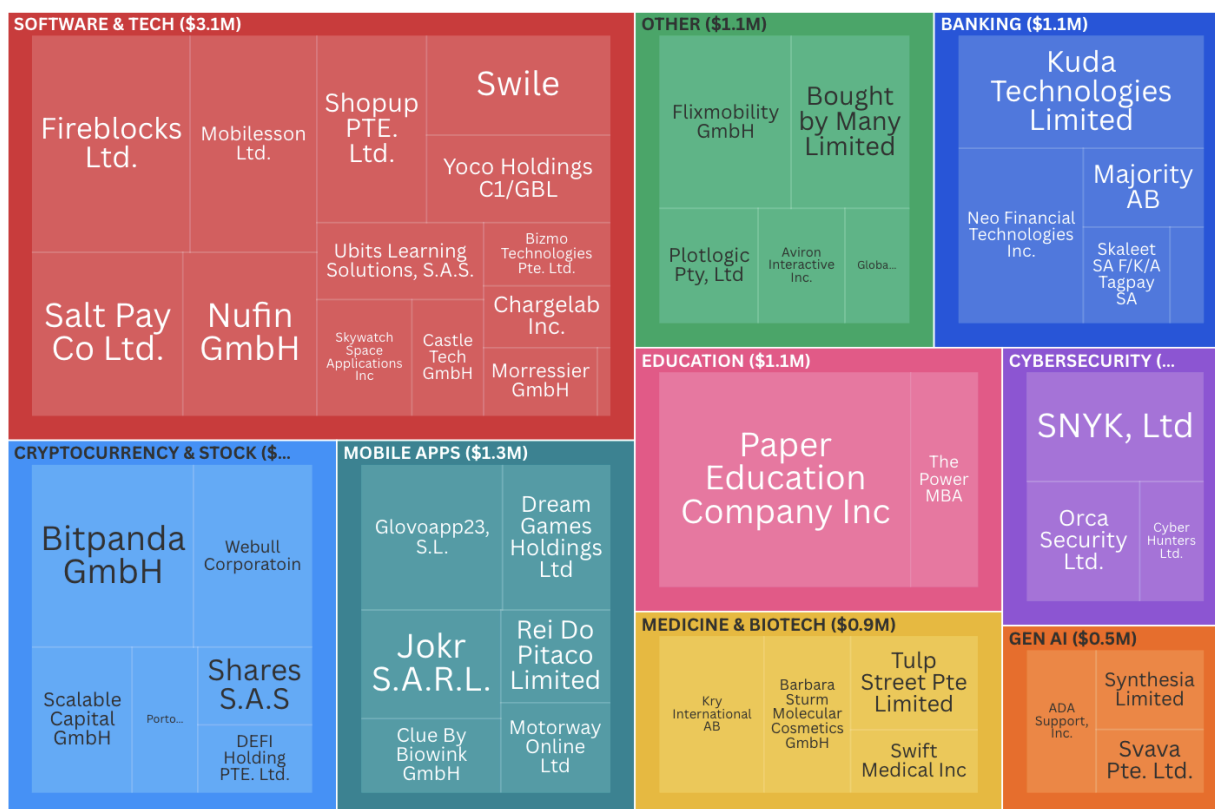


The Review uncovered the documents – which appear as an appendix to the College’s 2021 990-T nonprofit income tax return – in a publicly available database maintained by the Internal Revenue Service (IRS). They include 154 pages of disclosures filed under Treasury regulation 1.351-3(a), which requires corporations to disclose significant investments in foreign-controlled entities. While the publication of an annual 990-T is routine, the inclusion of attachments is not.

TK, talk to an accountant

The documents, while five years out of date, offer unprecedented insight into more than 70 companies in which the College’s fund managers purchased a financial stake. They range from Rei Do Pitaco Limited (\$160K) – a Brazilian sports betting platform – to the period-tracking app Clue (\$161K).

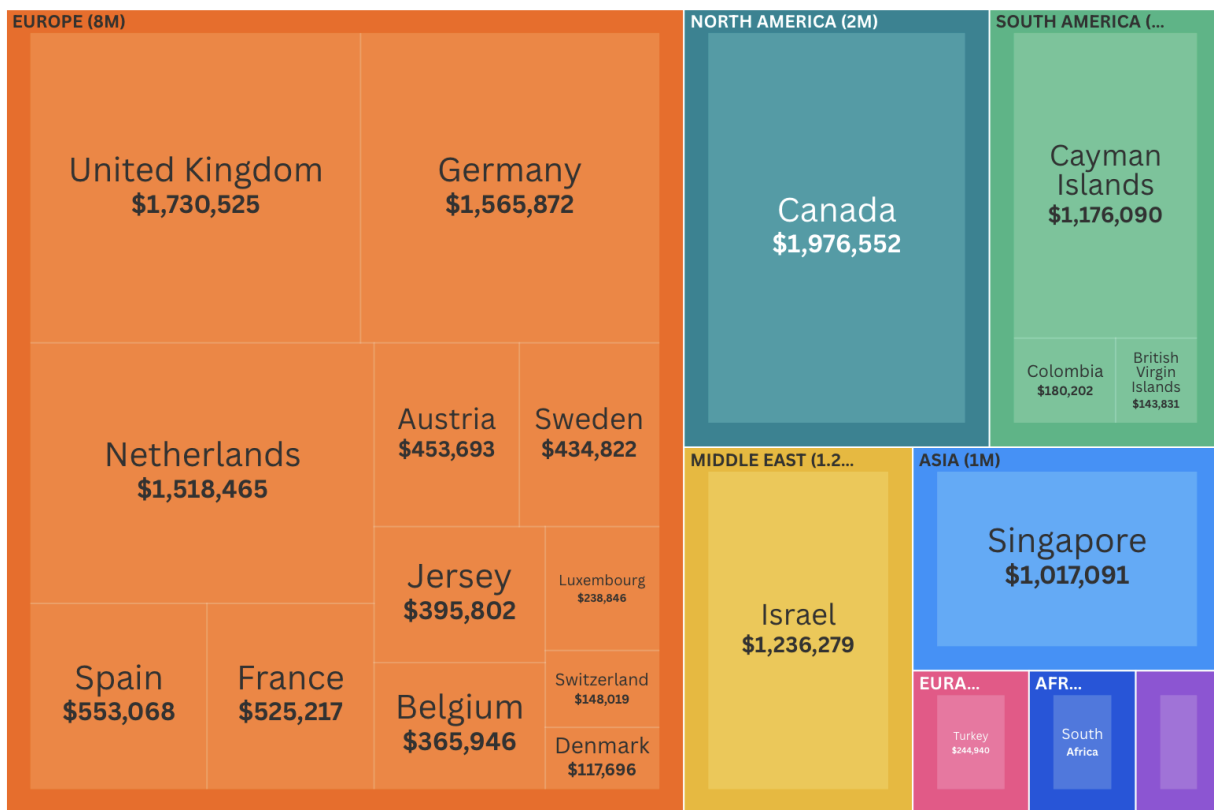
Software and tech startups led the College’s portfolio, with more than \$3 million invested in companies in that sector. A further \$1.4 million went to cryptocurrency and stock trading platforms, and \$1.2 million to companies that develop mobile apps or games. Three of the College’s investments that year – ADA Support (\$192K), Synthesia Limited (\$167K), and Svava (\$133K) – now market generative AI services as their primary product.



In June of 2021, the College’s fund managers purchased a \$873K stake in Paper Education Company, Inc – a Canadian startup that promised to provide K-12 students with one on one

virtual tutoring. The company has since been accused of misleading customers, after internal records showed that tutors spent at least 45% of their time working with multiple students at once as a cost-saving measure.

The College's fund managers invested heavily in companies in Europe, with more than \$8M distributed to 35 companies in that region. North and South America followed, with a combined \$3.5M invested across 14 companies.



Only two companies operating in Africa received investments from the College's fund managers. Kuda (\$442K), a mobile banking app, is incorporated in London, but operates in Nigeria out of its Lagos office. Yoco (\$225K), which produces mobile card readers for restaurants and small businesses, is based in South Africa.

TK, comment from the college

A complete database of Oberlin's foreign investments in the 2021-22 fiscal year is available at oberlinreview.org.

Company	Country	Investment	Sector	Description	Date
Rehab and Mental Healthcare Group B.V.	Netherlands	\$962,628	NA	[No verifiable details]	Various
Paper Education Company Inc	Canada	\$873,406	Education	Live tutoring for K-12 students	6/22/2021
Fireblocks Ltd.	Israel	\$477,298	Software & Tech	Backend infrastructure for digital money transfers and cryptocurrency	2/18/2021
Bitpanda GmbH	Austria	\$453,693	Cryptocurrency & Stock	Cryptocurrency and stock trading app marketed to beginners	10/14/2021
Kuda Technologies Limited	United Kingdom	\$441,681	Banking	Mobile banking app based in Africa	8/3/2021
Blue Phoenix Holding B.V.	Netherlands	\$413,016	NA	[No verifiable details]	Various
PW Real Estate Fund III Feeder LP	Jersey	\$395,802	NA	[No verifiable details]	7/29/2021
Mobilesson Ltd.	Israel	\$384,713	Software & Tech	HR software	12/22/2021
Apollo Topco B.V.	Belgium	\$365,946	NA	[No verifiable details]	Various
Flixbmobility GmbH	Germany	\$363,408	Other	Cheap long-distance bus travel in the United States	6/4/2021